

Recognise the constancy of the sine, cosine and tangent ratios for a given angle in right-angled triangles using properties of similarity

Learning intention

- recognise the constancy of the sine, cosine and tangent ratios for a given angle in right-angled triangles using properties of similarity.

Teach and model

- relating the tangent of an angle to the altitude and base of nested similar right-angled triangles.
- investigating patterns to reason about nested similar triangles that are aligned on a coordinate plane.
- understanding the terms “base”, “altitude”, “hypotenuse”, and “adjacent” and “opposite” sides to an angle, in a right-angled triangle.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

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Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.